

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/4: CLASSIFICATION AND LANGUAGE RAIL

TOPIC 11 MASTER SPINE

START -> family != script != register != status

-> Indo-Aryan / Dravidian / Austroasiatic / Tibeto-Burman

-> Sanskrit / Pali / Prakrits / Apabhramsha / vernacular public

-> keep coexistence, not replacement, at the centre

PYQ USE -> category trap questions, language-status confusion, register questions

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/4: SCRIPT AND EPIGRAPHY RAIL

SCRIPT HISTORY

Harappan undeciphered

- > Ashoka: Prakrit-Brahmi / Kharoshthi / Greek-Aramaic
- > epigraphy + palaeography as source disciplines
- > Prinsep 1837 for Mauryan Brahmi decipherment
- > regional scripts: Grantha / Sharada / Gurmukhi / Modi / Ol Chiki / Nandinagari

RULE -> script name is not the same as language family or legal status

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/4: MANUSCRIPTS AND CORPORA

TEXT AS MATERIAL WITNESS

oral formation -> manuscript copy -> commentary / colophon -> critical edition

palm leaf / birch bark / preservation / recopying / digitisation

corpora -> Vedic / epic / Buddhist / Jain / Sangam / classical Sanskrit

caution -> composition date != surviving manuscript date != edition date

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/4: CURRENT STATUS, PLACE VALUE AND ANSWER ROUTE

CURRENT LEDGER CHECKED 6 SEP 2026

Article 343 -> official language of the Union

Eighth Schedule -> 22

classical languages -> 11 after Oct 2024 additions

revised criteria -> antiquity 1500-2000 years -> heritage corpus

-> prose + epigraphical / inscriptional evidence

-> distinct or discontinuous from later forms

Sahitya Akademi working field -> 24

Bakhshali / place-value -> date discipline, not slogan history

Gyan Bharatam survey -> identify -> verify -> metadata -> conserve / digitise

FINAL ROUTE -> named evidence + qualification + no invented current totals